

On the bottom left, we have 3 different toggles – the first one is pre-activated is the default view, the two other modes to its right, trigger a few more numerical columns to appear in the timeline panel. To the right of that, below the time bars, is a meter. This is a zoom meter that can determine how minute you want to get into the time aspect – zooming in will reduce the unit time to smaller units and increase the size of the time bars.

And most importantly, there's the current time panel which is the blue line that's placed at 0 seconds at the start of a project. Once you hit the spacebar, the preview starts and you will see that the video plays but the blue current time marker stays stationary. You will notice that when it is playing, a red line starts moving in the timeline panel and once you hit pause, it disappears and the blue current time line has moved to how much ever seconds forward the video time has moved.



5. Properties of a layer (Visibility, audio, lock)
6. Layer colour
7. Effects toggle
8. 3D maneuvering
9. Linking
10. Mini section (adjusting the start/stop blue markers)
11. RAM preview

There's just so many controls in the timeline panel that it's easy to lose track of them.

The left most toggle is the visibility toggle with the eye icon. Toggling it on or off determines if we can see a layer or not. Next to it on the right is the audio icon, this quite self explanatorily determines whether audio from a file plays or not (notice that this is applicable only for audio files or video files that have audio). Right of that is the Lock icon – once locked, you won't be able to edit these layers. A great feature which keeps you from altering the already finalised layers. This is especially useful when you can't toggle off the visibility of other layers because you need to see how they interact with each other but at the same time you don't want to make any more modifications to this layer.

Then there's the colour bar for each layer. If you click on the tiny coloured square next to the layer number, you have a variety of colour options to choose from. You can also choose to label group an element so as to keep certain elements which are grouped or linked in the same colour.

On the right side of the layer name are a bunch of toggles and switches